

COMP101
Introduction to Programming
2025-26

Lab-01 Week-01
Drop-In – no supervision

Workbook-01
Access/Download Python

Download/access Python

Exercise 1

1.1 In labs:

Explore access to Python – check where it is and that you can get in and out of it okay.

1.2 Optional:

Download onto your personal machine from the official Python site.

<https://www.python.org/downloads/>

Latest stable version is Python 3.13.7

The 64-bit version gives improved performance.

Don't download below v3.9 as earlier versions will be unsupported or be incompatible with higher versions.

Python download is free, does not take up much space and is safe to use.

A download from the official Python site onto your own machine allows you to work in your own time, pace and location.

It has good functionality and 'programmability', i.e. it's easy to install and use.

In COMP101 we all use close enough to the same version so any issues will apply to us all and we can these quickly.

Don't download any Python Packages or libraries – only download and use the official Python download from the Python.org site.

COMP101 needs you to learn how to program.

There are software packages that contain Python alongside other utilities and support tools, e.g. Jupyter Notebook, PyCharm, SciPy etc

Some of these packages have routines that can do some of the programming for you: They take a while to learn and assessment is affected if the code is not your own code but is done by a machine.

Python on your own machine?

Students don't officially need a personal computer – all work can be done on University resources (Labs, teaching centres)

For use on a personal computer we specify a minimum requirement and a recommended specification:

Intel i5 or i7 or equivalent

At least 8GB RAM (should be aiming for 16GB or more)

At least 13.5" display at 1080p preferably with monitor/VDU
or at least 24" at least 1920 x 1080p

Separate keyboard and mouse

A tablet or smartphone will simply not meet these specifications and we therefore have no obligation to support them.